Whitney Kotlewski, PhD

VP of Product | Product Strategy & Portfolio Leadership | AI, Data & Spatial Platforms

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Product executive with 17+ years across strategy, design, research, and customer experience. Builds multidisciplinary organizations and leads platforms from vision through launch. Combines commercial thinking with expertise in AI, data visualization, spatial analytics, and digital twins across enterprise software and mission-critical operations.

CORE SKILLS

Product strategy | Portfolio management | Roadmap prioritization | Customer discovery | Go-to-market | Sales enablement | Opportunity sizing | Organizational leadership | Hiring & budgeting | AI/ML | Data platforms | Design systems

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Slingshot Aerospace | Apr 2024 - Present

Vice President of Product | Apr 2026 - Present
Senior Director of Product | 2025 - 2026; Head of Product Design & Research | 2024 - 2025

- Led delivery of Slingshot Portal's reusable platform in 2 months; reached 600+ users in under 4 months after general availability. Own vision and roadmaps for space operations intelligence and autonomy.
- Established a biweekly release cadence, enabling consistent delivery and deeper measurement of adoption, usage, and customer feedback to validate product decisions and inform roadmap priorities.
- Report to the CTO; grew the product organization from 3 to 19 across product management, strategy, design, research, customer experience, and space data in the U.S. and U.K.
- Partner with GTM and leadership on sales, demonstrations, and strategic opportunities during a tenure encompassing ~$124M in company capital raised and $96M+ in U.S. Space Force awards, including $27M for AI training and a $69.2M Phase III contract.
- Built Product Superbase, an AI-enabled framework connecting strategy, user research, decisions, and delivery evidence to team workflows; improved transparency, traceability, and roadmap alignment.
- Established shared product and marketing design systems with ~240 tokens and 1,200+ mission-operations components to support reuse across platform experiences.

Matterport | Apr 2021 - Oct 2023

Director, Product Design - Platform & Services

- Led design across eight platform experiences spanning web, marketplace, eCommerce, cloud, and developer tools following a ~$2.9B public listing. Company revenue grew from ~$111M to ~$158M and subscribers from ~503K to ~938K by FY2023.
- Scaled design from 1 to 8 and helped expand the broader organization from 6 to 20; led hiring, organizational planning, budgeting, and strategic planning.
- Integrated AI/ML into 3D digital twins; advanced research, accessibility, and design systems; partnered with Marketing on customer journeys, positioning, and launches.

Esri | Oct 2014 - Apr 2021

Head of UX Innovation & Special Programs | Dec 2019 - Apr 2021
Design Lead & Senior UX Architect | Oct 2014 - Dec 2019
Concurrent: Co-Founder & Director, Black Girls MAPP | Feb 2019 - May 2021

- Led enterprise product and UX innovation across analytics, drone mapping, mobile navigation, and 2D/3D GIS, including applied machine learning, as company revenue grew from ~$1.1B to $1.3B+.
- Led a five-person design team and co-founded a 150+ person civic technology initiative delivering 24 maps, 24 data layers, 59 apps, and 10 civic products; recognized with the 2021 AAG Diversity & Inclusion Award.

ADVISORY, TEACHING & EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Sonara | Executive Design Advisor / Advisory Board Member | Jul 2022 - Oct 2023
Advised the CEO and CIO on experience strategy and operational improvements; helped grow subscription purchases from ~50 to ~4,000 (~80x). Acquired by BOLD in 2024.

Claremont Graduate University | Adjunct Professor | Aug 2024 - Present
Created Design for Good, the university's first-ever novel incubator program and course.

Pacific Life | Customer Experience Lead & Research Consultant | Feb - Oct 2014
IUPUI | UX Design Lead, Instructor & Researcher | Jul 2010 - Jul 2013
Various Companies | Media, Web & Print Designer | Apr 2009 - Jul 2013

EDUCATION & RESEARCH

PhD, Information Systems & Technology | Claremont Graduate University | 2024
AI and data visualization dissertation; patent pending.
MS, Informatics | Indiana University-Purdue University Indianapolis
MS, Human-Computer Interaction; BA | Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute